



Maine Organization for Blind Athletic
and Leadership Education

SUMMER, 2026
MOBALE.org



The very first
“Wildcat Blind Sports
Education Camp”,
held from June 28-
July 2, 2026, at the
University of New
Hampshire’s Durham
campus was
**“Wildly”
successful!**



Through the generous support of the **Gibney Family Foundation**, **Foreseeable Future Foundation**, and the **Amherst, NH Lions Club**, 13 youth athletes with visual impairment from 4 New England states participated in this unique collaboration of the UNH Department of Kinesiology’s Adapted Physical Education (APE) Graduate program and MOBALE, to present a wide array of sports and fitness activities to male and female athletes ranging in age from 9 to 17.

CAMP STAFF: MOBALE staff trained new volunteers and contributed their expertise on strategies and adaptations for youth with visual impairment as well as bringing adapted equipment designed to make it possible for them to be included in sports with their non-disabled peers. The staff included 4 adults with visual impairment who presented positive, role models of success and competence for the athletes. UNH graduate students in the Adaptive P.E. Program, who came to the camp from all over the U.S., did an amazing job of teaching and coaching athletes, bringing their experience and enthusiasm for adaptations to enable athletes with visual impairment to learn and develop skills that will enable them to be included in competitive sports and activities that promote a healthy lifestyle and are really, really **FUN!**



SPORTS: Returning sports included **wrestling, rock climbing, disc golf, swimming, beep kickball, yoga, track and field, fitness, and goalball.**





Making its debut in 2026, and what turned out to be a favorite of many athletes, was **skateboarding**. [First Push Syndicate](#) of Dover, NH, provided a skateboard and protective gear for each athlete along with adaptive equipment that made learning the sport safe and accessible. We were pleased to learn that a major goal of **First Push**, providing opportunity to learn new



skills that help develop self-confidence and resilience through inclusive sports in their school and home communities, closely aligns with that of MOBALE. The energetic staff were excited to learn strategies to include athletes with visual impairment and help them experience the excitement of propelling themselves along a gym floor and gaining the “feel” for how to balance on the board. A frequent request heard from athletes on skateboards was, **“go faster”!**

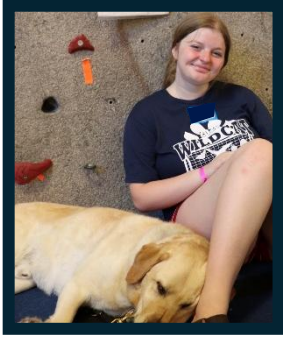


While extreme heat on the last 2 days of camp curtailed our track and field events, athletes did experience an introduction to adaptations to running, shot put and long jump events. We look forward to building on those skills at future camps.

A highlight of the goalball instruction and competition was our first year with “official” goalball nets and goalball eyeshades, which MOBALE was able to purchase with the generous donations by the Foreseeable Future Foundation and the Amherst, NH Lions Club. The nets were easy to assemble and sturdy, which added a new feel of “professionalism” to the game. We were also able to replace some worn out protective pads, so each player was comfortably outfitted for play.



AWARDS: Although we lost power with a demand overload of the electrical system in the extreme heat, awards were presented on the final day of camp, recognizing winners of the disc golf & goalball competitions. Annual recognition awards were presented to **Athlete of the Year, Opal S; Spirit Award, Hayden A.; Volunteer of the Year, Cora A.; and Organization of the Year, Gibney Family Foundation.** Unfortunately, without power, we were not able to hear from our speaker, Drew Crook, originally from Amherst, NH, a member of the Boston Renegades Beep Baseball team. We are working with Drew to create a video that will showcase his story, experience, and success as an athlete with a visual impairment that we will post on our website to share with athletes & their families.



FUTURE: We will send a post-camp survey to athletes/families and camp staff to get feedback on all aspects of the camp as we embark on planning for the future. MOBALE hopes to engage with UNH and First Push Syndicate to expand sports opportunities for athletes with visual impairment. We will keep you posted on developments and welcome your questions and comments on our programs.



THANKS TO OUR GENEROUS SPONSORS: Click the links below to learn about these wonderful organizations that support individuals with visual impairment.

[Gibney Family Foundation](#)

[Foreseeable Future Foundation](#)

[Lions Club of Amherst, NH](#)

[Smitty's Wrestling Barn](#)

PHOTO GALLERY

Jack kicks the beep kickball



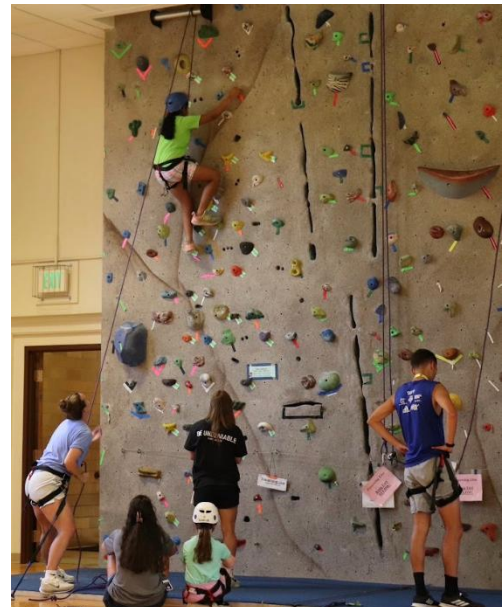
Landon throws the goalball



John learns to put the shot



Opal climbs to the top of the wall



Group warm-ups at the track



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MORE PHOTOS . . .

Stephen throws the goalball,
teammate Kayla in center position



John dives as Vivi blocks



Matt from Smitty's coaches wrestlers



Skateboarding



Shane throws the ball to score a goal



Rory skateboards with adaptation



TO SEE ADDITIONAL PHOTOS, PLEASE VISIT OUR WEBSITE
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